

have ever wanted to get into the game of making a game, maybe you would want to look at game design as a career. Interested? Read on!

What it is, what it isn't

Game design is the craft of knowing how hurling disgruntled birds on a stack of pigs can actually be fun for millions of people on the planet while making a franchise worth billions of dollars. Well, kind of.

Academically speaking, you could say that Game Design is an art and a science. It is the art of envisioning the storyline, content and rules of a game; while it is the science of examining the psychology of the player and his relationship with the game. In short, game design involves figuring out what will get a player hooked to a game and what won't... and creating games that will work.

So who is the mastermind that uses game design theories to create a successful game? (drumroll please): the Game Designer!

A Game Designer is someone who has a vision of what the game is as it goes through iterations during its development cycle. Any game you see in the market is usually the brainchild of a Game Designer. You could say that he is the one who makes sure that a Half life game plays and feels like a Half life game. He doesn't design the artwork or do the programming; he is to a game what a director is to a movie—he can make or break a game concept.

In fact, contrary to popular belief, Game Design doesn't just mean designing video games for PC/Consoles... it could also mean designing board, card or live action games. Game Design is also used by companies to 'gamify' less interesting activities for their employees or customers.

Myths and Expectations

So, first things first: Game Design isn't Programming. Game Design isn't Character Design or Animation. Game Design isn't Story Writing for Games and Game Design surely isn't Game Testing. If you have been a die-hard gamer and you think you would want to make games because you can play games—you would be disappointed to know that it doesn't qualify you to become a Game Designer. Yes, being a gamer does help. However, a Game Designer has to enter the industry with minimal bias towards all kinds of games; Games that are played by players from varied age groups, genders and geographies; on varied platforms and with varied play times.

As a Game Designer it's unlikely that your first project will be a God of War 4 or a similarly huge AAA blockbuster title. It's likely, that at